

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY



ACTOR REPORT

**Southeast Asian APT Group Saaiwc
Targets Military and Financial
Departments with Custom Tools**

Date of Publication

January 10, 2023

Last Update Date

January 11, 2023

Admiralty code

A1

TA Number

TA2023014

Summary

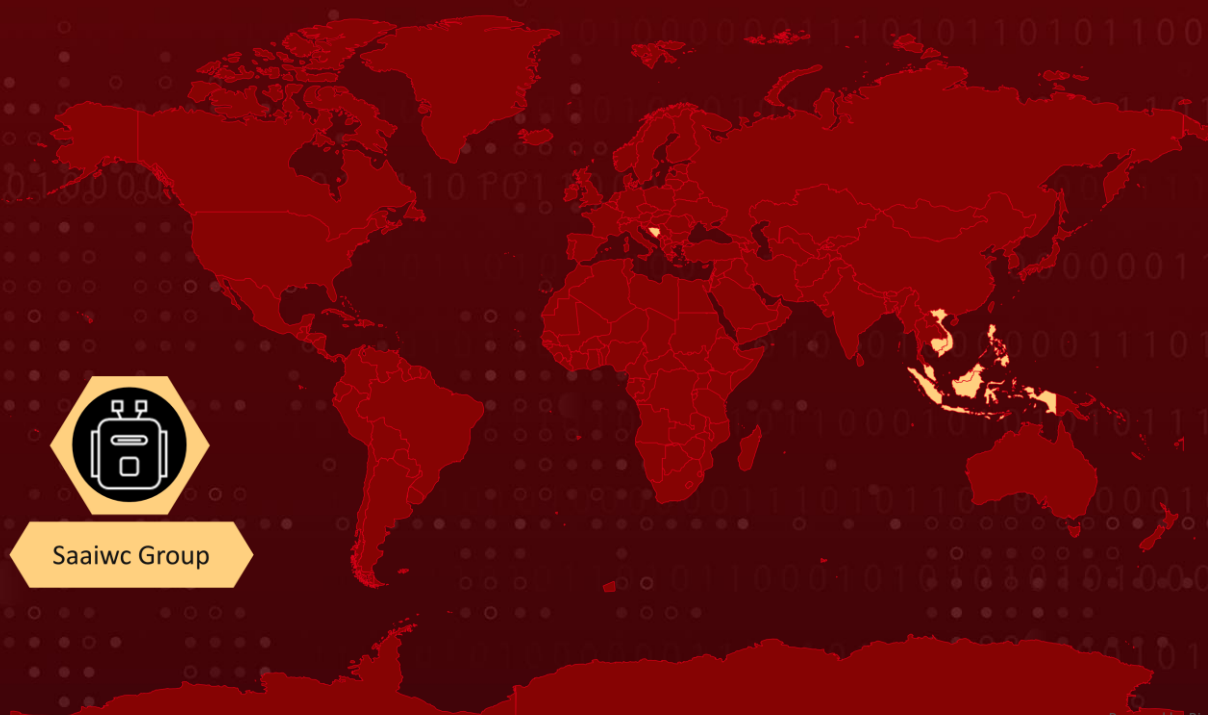
First Appearance: May 2022

Actor Name: Saaiwc Group (APT-LY-1005, Dark Pink)

Target Countries: Vietnam, Malaysia, Indonesia, Cambodia, Philippines, Bosnia and Herzegovina

Target Sectors: Military, Government, Development, Religious, and Non-profit

Actor Map



Powered by Bing
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CVE

CVE	NAME	PATCH
CVE-2017-0199	Microsoft Office/WordPad Remote Code Execution Vulnerability w/Windows	

Actor Details

#1

The Saaiwc Group is a newly identified APT group believed to be a mixture of nation-state threat actors from China, North Korea, Iran, and Pakistan. They primarily use an ISO file as a malicious payload, which when executed, injects a PowerShell command into the local registry and loads a PowerShell backdoor called PowerDism. This enables them to exfiltrate information and execute arbitrary commands on targeted systems.

#2

Their main tactic is to use targeted spear-phishing emails as the initial vector, posing as job applicants and crafting unique emails by scanning online job vacancy portals. They use custom and self-made tools such as TelePowerBot, KamiKakaBot, Cucky, and Ctealer stealers and the PowerSploit/Get-MicrophoneAudio tool as a public tool.

#3

They utilize techniques like Event Triggered Execution, Change Default File Association to launch malware, and DLL Side-Loading to avoid detection. They also use a set of PowerShell scripts to communicate with their infrastructure, move laterally and conduct network reconnaissance. All communication between infected systems and the group is done via Telegram API.

#4

To evade detection, they also use decoy files that mimic meeting and training notices from the Philippine Army and the Cambodian Ministry of Economy and Finance. The group is also known to exploit the vulnerability CVE-2017-0199 and use the PowerDism Backdoor in their attack campaigns.

Actor Group

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET COUNTRIES	TARGET INDUSTRIES
Saaiwc Group (APT-LY-1005, Dark Pink)	China, North Korea, Iran, and Pakistan	Vietnam, Malaysia, Indonesia, Cambodia, Philippines, Bosnia and Herzegovina	Military, Government, Development, Religious, and Non-profit
	MOTIVE		
	Information Theft & espionage		

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actor through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5’s Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the ‘Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs’ & ‘Indicators of Compromise (IoC)’ on the following pages.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control
<u>TA0003</u> Persistence	<u>TA0004</u> Privilege Escalation	<u>TA0007</u> Discovery	<u>T1204</u> User Execution
<u>T1059</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter	<u>T1059.001</u> PowerShell	<u>T1012</u> Query Registry	<u>T1047</u> Windows Management Instrumentation
<u>T1132</u> Data Encoding	<u>T1036</u> Masquerading	<u>T1036.005</u> Match Legitimate Name or Location	<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information
<u>T1027.002</u> Software Packing	<u>T1083</u> File and Directory Discovery	<u>T1497</u> Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion	<u>T1569</u> System Services
<u>T1123</u> Audio Capture	<u>T1113</u> Screen Capture	<u>T1102</u> Web Service	<u>T1140</u> Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information
<u>T1176</u> Browser Extensions	<u>T1555</u> Credentials from Password Stores	<u>T1082</u> System Information Discovery	<u>T1127</u> Trusted Developer Utilities Proxy Execution

<u>T1548</u> Abuse Elevation Control Mechanism	<u>T1548.002</u> Bypass User Account Control	<u>T1546</u> Event Triggered Execution	<u>T1546.001</u> Change Default File Association
<u>T1221</u> Template Injection	<u>T1574</u> Hijack Execution Flow	<u>T1574.002</u> DLL Side-Loading	<u>T1547</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution
<u>T1569.002</u> Service Execution	<u>T1566</u> Phishing	<u>T1053</u> Scheduled Task/Job	

✂

Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
MD5	edcd5ff1c2af9451405d430052c60660 a6e085c099d681a71b937631a5e88c06 c6abce3f12c14b7804a2532a3f5199b7 f02a96b84231da7626399ff1ca6fb33f 926027f0308481610c85f4e3e433573b 728afa40b20df6d2540648ef845eb754 7eaf1b65004421ac07c6bb1a997487b2 732091ad428419247bce87603ea79f00
SHA1	d8df672ecd9018f3f2d23e5c966535c30a54b71d 18ca159183c98f52df45d3e9db0087e17596a866 142f909c26bd57969ef93d7942587cdf15910e34 24f65e0ee158fc63d98352f9828d014ab239ae16
SHA256	9976625b5a3035dc68e878ad5ac3682ccb74ef2007c501c8023291548e11301a c60f778641942b7b0c00f3214211b137b683e8296abb1905d2557bfb245bf775 e3181ee97d3ffd31c22c2c303c6e75d0196912083d0c21536e5833ee7d108736 e45df7418ca47a9a4c4803697f4b28c618469c6e5a5678213ab81df9fcc9fd51
File Path	\$env:tmp\backuplog \$env:tmp\backuplog1 \$env:appdata\archive.zip \$env:appdata\telegram.txt \$env:tmp\afkslfsa.csv \$env:tmp\AB.zip \$Env:tmp\AB
Mutex	gwgXSznM-Jz92k33A-uRcCCksA-9XAU93r5

✂ Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
Registry path	HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\.4ID\ HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\.abcd HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\.psr HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\.zol HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\.zolo HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\4IDfile\shell\open\command HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\4IDfile\shell\open\command\ HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\abcdfile\shell HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\abcdfile\shell\aaaa HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\abcdfile\shell\abcd HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\abcdfile\shell\open\command HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\abcdfile\shell\open\command\abcd HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\psrfile\shell\open\command HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\zolfile\shell\open\command\zolo HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\zolofile\shell\open\command HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\zolofile\shell\open\command -Name DelegateExecute HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\zolofile\shell\open\command -Name DelegateExecute HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\zolofile\shell\open\command -Name zolo HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\zolofile\shell\open\command -Name zolo - Value HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Classes\zolofile\shell\open\command\zolo HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Forfiles HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Psr HKCU:\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Recents

✂ Patch Link

<https://msrc.microsoft.com/update-guide/en-US/vulnerability/CVE-2017-0199>

✂ References

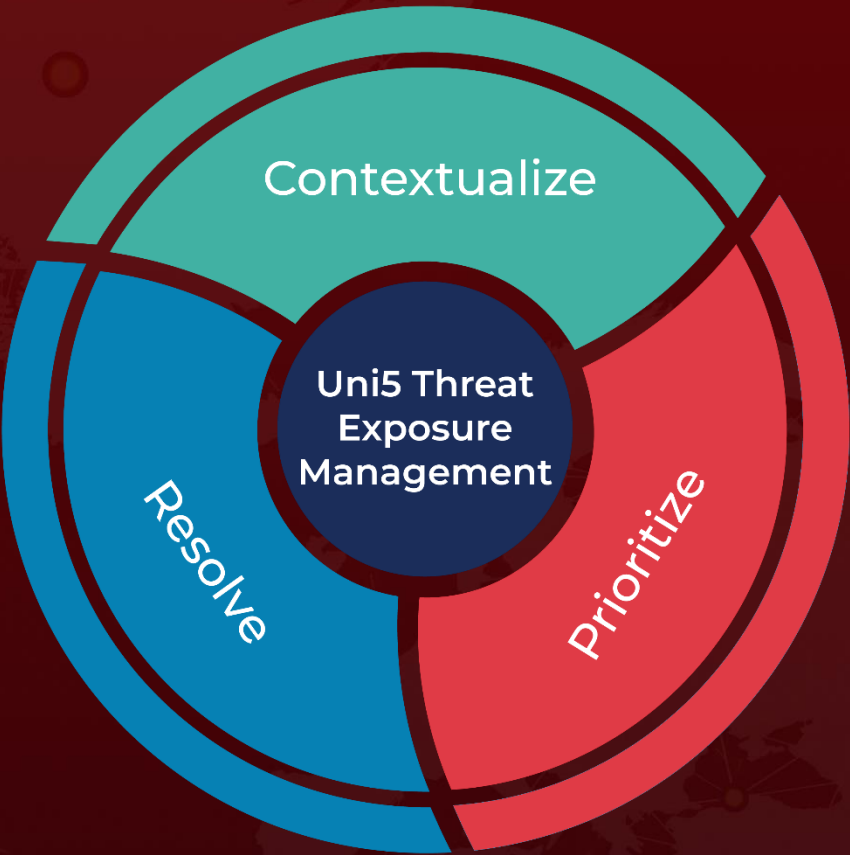
<https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/G3gUjg9WC96NW4cRPww6gw>

<https://blog.group-ib.com/dark-pink-apt>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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